
ATNLP: Lecture 30

Exam Overview

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What have we had over the years?

- Computational linguistics
- Natural language processing
- Large language modelling

Quick history of NLP

- 1980s-1990s: rule-based systems in NLP
- 1990s-2010s: statistical NLP
- 2010s-present: deep learning technology for NLP
- “We can’t predict the future, but we can create it...” - anyone volunteers?

Solving the exam...



Content and Format

- The exam will cover all material in lectures 1–30, not including guest lectures.
- It will contain 3 questions. Mixture of open-ended questions and multiple choice questions. Questions are split into 20-20-10 points, total of 50.
- Each subquestion will indicate how much it is worth.
- You will have **two hours** to complete the exam.

Please check <https://exams.is.ed.ac.uk/> for the most up-to-date information

What I saw last:

INFR11287: Advanced Topics in Natural Language Processing (INFR11287 and INFR11288)

Venue

St Leonards Land Gym 2 (Enter via Viewcraig Gardens)

Date: Wednesday, 20th May 2026

Time: 9:30 a.m. to 11:30 a.m.

Duration: 2:00

INFR11288: Advanced Topics in Natural Language Processing (INFR11287 and INFR11288)

Venue

St Leonards Land Dance Studio (Enter via Viewcraig Gardens)

Date: Wednesday, 20th May 2026

Time: 9:30 a.m. to 11:30 a.m.

Duration: 2:00

Content and Format

- The exam will be held in-person and will be invigilated.
- The exam is **closed book**, which means no notes, books, calculators or any other aids are permitted.
- You will write your answers into the exam booklet. Please be careful to use the space that's provided for each question in the booklet.
- The exam will be marked electronically using Gradescope.

What to Revise

- Revise the content of the lectures.
- Study the readings and also the tutorial questions.
- From the readings, only the required readings are examinable, but the additional readings may reinforce concepts and can give you a feel for how to use concepts in new settings.
- The exam will focus on analysis and synthesis. You will need to understand fundamental models and how to apply them to new problems.

How to Revise

- Don't wait until the last minute. Study early and often. Research shows that spaced repetition is the most effective way to remember material.
- Write revision notes. For example, try to summarize the course in one or two pages.
- Creating one or two pages of key information forces you to consider what is most important in the course, what you can remember, and what you still have to revise.

How to Revise

- Study actively: Simply reading information is not a good way to remember or understand it.
- Work through examples, making sure you get the correct answer, and think about what questions we might ask related to that material.
- Ask yourself how different parts of the course connect to each other. What are the different themes? What are different ways to approach some of the tasks?
- Consider the types of questions we might ask, and how they would apply to different parts of the course:
 - Applying a method, model or concept to a particular situation.
 - Analysing, evaluating, or comparing one or more methods.
 - Synthesising knowledge to address a new situation.

How to Get Help

If you are stuck during exam revision:

- The TA and/or the lecturers will hold office hours before the exam.
- Questions on Piazza are welcome at any time before the exam. Piazza will be closed 24 hours before the exam to allow us to answer to everything, and prevent stressing students.

How to Practice

- Practice exam-taking. Don't just think about your answers: write them out by hand, and give yourself time limits.
- Practice questions from the tutorial sheets – you may see similar questions in the exam.
- Practice using old exams (<https://exampapers.ed.ac.uk>)
- see exam guide about that
- If the material in one of these exams was not covered in class, you can ignore it
- **No model answers are provided for previous exams.**

How to Sit the Exam

- You will be expected to answer all questions. There are no optional questions.
- Pay attention to the allocation of points. If a question is worth 1 or 2 points, a short answer is expected: a sentence or two.
- Read the whole exam and make a plan. Allocate enough time for each question.
- You will need to write out your answers by hand. Make sure your writing is legible!
- Multiple choice questions are usually easier, try to ensure you go over them

Good luck!

Please check the *Exam Guide* on the course webpage!

Please fill-in the NSS and PTES (you received an email)!

NSS: <https://www.thestudentsurvey.com/> for UG

PTES: <https://app.onlinesurveys.jisc.ac.uk/s/edinburgh/ptes-2026> for MSc